SSC (Shared Services Canada) just released its 2026–27 plan. They will:

- Invest in **sovereign AI**, cloud, security, and data (Link)
- Build a **Sovereign AI Platform** and scale CANChat on Canadian cloud (Link)
- Apply the **Buy Canadian** policy to more contracts (from 25M down to 5M by June 2026)

This is a real shift in federal IT buying, not just a policy slide.canada+1

## Our purpose

We are a small group (6 people) with one goal:

Use public data to find one real, Canadian product or service idea that fits SSC's plan and Buy Canadian timelines and shape it enough that a serious founder or investor would listen.

This is not a case. We only continue if we are **committed** and **compassionate** about building something tangible.

**Meeting**

- **Kickoff:** Wednesday, March 25, 5:00–5:30 PM (30 min)
- We will:
    - Align on purpose
    - Assign light roles
    - Define what we each do before the next meeting

If you join, I ask that you:

- Show up each week (no ghosting)
- Spend about 1–1.5 hours between meetings doing focused, simple tasks
- Care about building something real for Canada (not just adding a line on LinkedIn)

# What kind of product can come from this?

From SSC's plan and Buy Canadian policy, some **concrete, AI-enabled product ideas** you could discover or refine by scanning data.

1. **Sovereign AI Monitoring & Compliance Hub**

    - Problem: SSC is building a Sovereign AI Platform for Protected B workloads on Canadian cloud; they must prove data stays in Canada and models follow policy.canada+1
    - Product: A Canadian SaaS platform that tracks where AI workloads run, what data is used, and creates audit reports for SSC and departments.

- Revenue: Subscription + implementation fees.

2. **AI-powered Contract Risk and Renewal Advisor (Canadian-first)**

   - Problem: SSC has a large number of legacy, long contracts with foreign vendors; Buy Canadian pushes them to shift.govcanadacontracts+1
   - Product: AI tool that reads existing SSC contracts + amendments and flags where:
     - foreign vendors are at risk under Buy Canadian,
     - renewal dates are coming, and
     - there is no strong Canadian alternative yet.
   - Target user: SSC procurement teams and Canadian vendors selling into SSC.

3. **Sovereign Backup & Disaster Recovery Planning Tool**

   - Problem: SSC needs Canadian-based backup for critical data as part of sovereign cloud hosting.canada
   - Product: A planning and simulation tool (with AI) that helps departments design and test Canada-based backup strategies across hybrid cloud and data centres.

4. **Zero Trust "Quick Wins" Insights for SSC**

   - Problem: SSC is rolling out Zero Trust security across departments.publications+1
   - Product: Analytics + AI that ingest existing infrastructure and incident data and show top 10 quick Zero Trust changes that reduce risk with minimal cost.

These are examples you can put on the table to make it real. Your group will either refine one or find a better one from the data.

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# What to scan (simple workflow)

Think in three layers: **plans** → **spend** → **vendors.**

# Step 1 – Understand SSC's plan and timelines

Look for what SSC says it will do 2026–27.

- Read 2–3 sections of SSC's 2026–27 Plan:
  - Digital sovereignty and Sovereign AI Platform
  - CANChat and AI services
  - Security / Zero Trust
  - Cloud and hosting

- From this, write down:
    - 3–5 priorities (e.g., “sovereign AI”, “backup on Canadian cloud”)
    - 3–5 phrases that sound like **problems** (e.g., “Protected B data”, “Auditor General findings on security”)

## Step 2 – Look at where money moves

Use high-level spend and results to see pressure and gaps.

- GC InfoBase – SSC:
    - Look at: IT operations, security, cloud/hosting, AI/analytics if visible.
    - Look at trend: are some areas growing or shrinking?
- Departmental results reports:
    - See where SSC missed or is close to targets (e.g., satisfaction, security metrics, cost targets).
    - Missed targets = pain point = product opportunity.

## Step 3 – Look at vendor patterns

Use contract data to see who is in and who might be out.

- Government of Canada Contract Analysis - filter for **Shared Services Canada** (govcanadacontracts) - https://govcanadacontracts.ca/departments/ssc-spc/
    - Top 10 vendors by contract value.
    - Which are US/global vs Canadian?
    - Which contracts look “legacy” (old start dates, many amendments)?
- Overlay Buy Canadian:
    - Policy applies to strategic procurements ≥25M now and ≥5M from June 15, 2026.
    - Ask: where are there big non-Canadian vendors in areas SSC wants to “Canadianize”?

## Step 4 – Turn into opportunity

For each possible area (AI, backup, security), try to answer:

- What is SSC trying to achieve? (from plan)
- Where are they under pressure? (missed targets, Auditor General notes, etc.)
- Who are the current vendors? Canadian or foreign?
- Where does Buy Canadian create a chance to switch?

Then write this as:

**"SSC wants X, has Y problem, currently buys from Z (not Canadian), and needs a Canadian, AI-enabled way to do A, B, C."**

That is your product entry point.

# 4. How to "crawl" with AI (practical)

Use AI (like me or another tool) as a force multiplier, not a black box. A simple loop:

1. **Ask AI to summarize SSC's needs**
    - Paste a small section of the SSC plan (e.g., Sovereign AI) and ask:
        - "Summarize SSC's needs and risks in this section in 5 bullet points."
2. **Ask AI for possible product angles**
    - Prompt:
        - "Given these needs, list 5 possible B2B SaaS or service products a Canadian company could build to solve them. For each, specify the main user and main value."
3. **Ask AI to compare with vendors**
    - After you collect some vendor names from contract data:
        - "These vendors are currently serving SSC in [area]. Given the product ideas above and the Buy Canadian rule (25M → 5M), where is there most room for a new Canadian player?"
4. **Ask AI to help refine one idea**
    - Take your favourite idea and ask:
        - "Stress-test this idea: what are the main risks, and how could a 3–5 person startup de-risk it in 12 months?"

You stay in control. AI just helps you move faster through text and make connections.

# 5. Quick Plan

- **Kickoff (Mar 25, 5–5:30 PM):** Align on purpose, pick roles, choose which SSC focus (sovereign AI, backup, security, or procurement analytics) we want to explore first.
- **Week 1 (before Apr 2):** Each person scans 1–2 sources (SSC plan, GC InfoBase, contract data) and brings 3 insights + 1 product idea.
- **Week 2 (Apr 2, 30–45 min):** Pick 1 opportunity, size it, and map users and value.
- **Week 3 (Apr 9, 30–45 min):** Draft a 1-page opportunity + simple product sketch.